James **Sheldon**

Founding engineer & CTO · Full-stack TypeScript · AI products

Calgary, Canada · Remote
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SUMMARY

Founding engineer and CTO who builds AI products end to end. Most recently I built Cashew Research's generative AI platform for market research and led its engineering team. I work across TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, GraphQL, and PostgreSQL, and I'm as comfortable setting technical direction as I am shipping features myself. Before Cashew, I built search and discovery at Contra and led technical work for clients like Nissan at Critical Mass.

SKILLS

Leadership: technical strategy, architecture, hiring, mentoring
Front-end: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js
Back-end: Node.js, GraphQL, tRPC, Temporal
Data: PostgreSQL, Prisma, ZenStack, MongoDB, MSSQL, Meilisearch
Testing and delivery: Playwright, Cypress, Jest, Vitest, mutation testing, CI/CD, Terraform
AI-assisted development: Claude Code, agent-based workflows

EXPERIENCE

Cashew Research

2024 – 2026

Chief Technology Officer (Founding Engineer) · Remote (Calgary)

- Built a generative AI platform for market research that wrote targeted survey questions, analyzed responses, and summarized the findings.
- Designed a methodology selection engine that recommended research approaches based on a study's goals.
- Chose and built the architecture: a Next.js and tRPC monorepo on PostgreSQL, with Temporal for long-running workflows.
- Designed the agent-based development system we built the platform with (Claude Code), using mutation testing as the quality gate for agent-written code.
- Owned infrastructure and delivery (Terraform, CI/CD), setting direction with our platform engineer.
- Led the engineering team, setting its technical direction, review standards, and delivery process.

Contra

Apr 2021 – Jan 2024

Senior Fullstack Engineer · Remote

- Designed and built search and discovery, the core of how clients find talent on Contra.
- Led the Search & Discovery and Jobs teams through core product projects, from design to production.
- Mentored teammates while working as both an individual contributor and team lead.

Critical Mass

Jan 2014 – Apr 2021

Tech Director, Tech Lead, Senior Developer · Calgary, Canada

- Set departmental practices and development standards with fellow tech directors and leads.
- Hired, mentored, and staffed developers, and supported their career development at the department level.
- Guided architecture decisions with project developers and leads, and ran technical consultations with clients and third-party vendors.
- Delivered Nissan and Infiniti's next-gen shopping tools and dealer inventory, the LodgeLink platform rebuild, the Nissan mobile rebuild, and a series of campaign vehicle configurators.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Sajak & Farki** · Front-end Developer. Built JavaScript admin dashboards and social campaigns; helped set build, development, and QA standards.
- **Valtech (formerly NLC)** · Developer. Built the front end of a performance-indicator dashboard with an agile team across North America.
- **Bryan Mills Iradesso** · Web Solutions Specialist. Managed developers and designers on corporate websites, intranets, and mobile apps; wrote RFP responses and requirements.
- **ZGM Modern Marketing Partners** · Lead Web Developer. Led a small team and built a custom .NET CMS with social, mapping, and payment integrations.
- **Sprung Instant Structures** · Web Developer / Graphic Designer. Built a photo management system for international marketing staff and maintained the company website.

EDUCATION

Mount Royal University · Bachelor of Communications, Electronic Publishing; Certificate of Arts and Sciences

Recommendations: linkedin.com/in/jamessheldon/details/recommendations